

Eshwar Chandrasekharan

Computer Science Ph.D.
eshwar3@gatech.edu
www.cc.gatech.edu/eshwar3

Georgia Institute of Technology
School of Interactive Computing
Technology Square Research Building

Research Interests

My research aims to computationally model abusive online behavior to build tools that help counter it, with the goal of making the Internet a more welcoming place. Broadly, I am interested in the language used in Social Media: linguistic differences, similarities, and unique properties that extend across or are specific to online communities.

Topics: Social Computing, Machine Learning, Natural Language Processing, Data Science, Hate Speech and Abusive Behavior in Online Communities.

Education

- **Georgia Institute of Technology** Atlanta, GA
Ph.D. in Computer Science 2015 - Present
 - Specialization: Social Computing
 - Advisor: Dr. Eric Gilbert
 - Anticipated graduation date: *Spring 2020*
- **Indian Institute of Technology Madras** Chennai, India
B.Tech & M.Tech in Computer Science 2010 - 2015
 - Specialization: Computer Science and Engineering
 - Advisor: Dr. Sutanu Chakraborti
 - Thesis: Footprints on Silicon: Explorations in Gathering Autobiographical Content

Publications

- **Crossmod: A Cross-Community Learning-based System to Assist Reddit Moderators**
(Under submission at CSCW 2019).
 - Eshwar Chandrasekharan, Chaitrali Gandhi, Matthew Wortley Mustelier, Eric Gilbert
- **Still out there: Modeling and Identifying Russian Troll Accounts on Twitter**
arXiv. (Under submission at CSCW 2019)
 - Jane Im, Eshwar Chandrasekharan, Jackson Sargent, Paige Lighthammer, Taylor Denby, Ankit Bhargava, Libby Hemphill, David Jurgens, Eric Gilbert
- **A Just and Comprehensive Strategy for Using NLP to Address Online Abuse**
ACL 2019. (forthcoming)
 - David Jurgens, Libby Hemphill, Eshwar Chandrasekharan
- **Managing and Designing for Norms in Online Communities**
ICWSM 2019. [Accepted as a full-day workshop]
 - Joseph Seering, Sanjay Kairam, Eshwar Chandrasekharan, Stevie Chancellor

- **Hybrid Approaches to Detect Comments Violating Macro Norms on Reddit**
arXiv. (dataset paper)
 - Eshwar Chandrasekharan, Eric Gilbert
- **Prevalence and Psychological Effects of Hateful Speech in Online College Communities**
WebSci 2019. (forthcoming)
 - Koustuv Saha, Eshwar Chandrasekharan, Munmun De Choudhury
- **The Internet's Hidden Rules: An Empirical Study of Reddit Norm Violations at Micro, Meso, and Macro Scales**
CSCW 2018. [Acceptance rate: 27%]
 - Eshwar Chandrasekharan, Mattia Samory, Shagun Jhaver, Hunter Charvat, Amy Bruckman, Cliff Lampe, Jacob Eisenstein, Eric Gilbert
- **You Can't Stay Here: The Efficacy of Reddit's 2015 Ban Examined Through Hate Speech**
CSCW 2017. [Acceptance rate: 27%]
 - Eshwar Chandrasekharan, Umashanthi Pavalanathan, Anirudh Srinivasan, Adam Glynn, Jacob Eisenstein, Eric Gilbert
- **The Bag of Communities: Identifying Abusive Behavior Online with Preexisting Internet Data**
CHI 2017. [Acceptance rate: 25%]
 - Eshwar Chandrasekharan, Mattia Samory, Anirudh Srinivasan, Eric Gilbert
- **Situated Anonymity: Impacts of Anonymity, Ephemerality, and Hyper-Locality on Social Media Platforms**
CHI 2017. [Acceptance rate: 25%]
 - Ari Schlesinger, Eshwar Chandrasekharan, Christina Masden, Amy Bruckman, W Keith Edwards, Rebecca Grinter
- **Footprints on Silicon: Explorations in Gathering Autobiographical Content**
CICLing 2015 (IJCLA). [Acceptance rate: 34%]
 - Eshwar Chandrasekharan, Sutanu Chakraborti

Professional Experience

- **Health ML Intern - Engineering**
Twitter Inc. *May - Aug. 2018*
 - Examined the landscape of incoming abuse reports on Twitter in a large-scale, empirical manner, in order to quantify the notion of *report quality*.
 - Identified the different types of abuse that are reported by users using a mixed-methods approach (computational and qualitative)
 - Presented approaches to build new ML tools to detect and discourage different types of abuse on the platform, and training the existing internal tools in a more nuanced manner.
 - Area of work: Machine Learning, Quantitative Research, Data Science
- **Data Science Intern**
BuzzFeed Inc. *May - Aug. 2017*
 - Developed a human-machine collaboration service which informs BuzzFeed's content distribution strategy on Facebook
 - Built machine learning models to predict which BuzzFeed links would perform best on certain Facebook pages, and identify which pages to post on for the most content shares
 - Area of work: Data Science, Machine Learning

- **Software Development Engineer (SDE) Intern**

- *Amazon Development Center (India) Pvt. Ltd., Bangalore*

May - July. 2013

- Automated product Opinion summarization of Amazon Customer Reviews
- Creating original content for product web pages to improve Search Engine Optimization
- Area of work: Opinion Mining, Sentiment Analysis, Text Summarization

- **Software Engineer Intern**

- *Amadasoft India Pvt. Ltd., IITM Research Park, Chennai*

May. - July. 2012

- Developed algorithms for performing multi-precision arithmetic using Double Representation of Floating point numbers
- Area of work: Number Theory, Optimized Algorithms

Selected Press

- Kevin Roose. *Reddit Limits Noxious Content by Giving Trolls Fewer Places to Gather*, The New York Times (2017)
- Devin Coldewey. *Study finds Reddit's controversial ban of its most toxic subreddits actually worked*, TechCrunch (2017)
- David Mitchell. *New Georgia Tech Research May Help Combat Abusive Online Comments*, Georgia Tech News Center (2017)

Awards & Achievements

- Accepted to the 2019 CSST Summer Institute at Rutgers University.
- Semi-finalist for the Snap Inc. Research Fellowship 2019.
- Winner, South East Asia Regional Computer Confederation (SEARCC) International Schools' Software Competition 2009 conducted by Computer Society of Sri Lanka, representing India at University of Colombo School of Computing, Colombo, Sri Lanka, 2009.
- First Prize in the National Finals of Young Talent Search in Computer Programming Contest 2009 conducted by the Computer Society of India, 2009.
- Recipient of National Talent Search Examination (NTSE) Scholarship, The National Council of Educational Research and Training (NCERT) in 2008; awarded to the top 750 students in India.
- School Topper, 10th Board Examination with total of 481/500 with 100% in Mathematics and 99% in Science; recipient of CBSE Merit certificate in 2008 - awarded to 0.1% of successful candidates in Science and Mathematics.

Invited Talks

- **“Combating Online Abusive Behavior Using Cross-Community Learning”** University of Michigan
Venue: School of Information, Ann Arbor, MI *February 2019*

- **“Effectiveness of *Banning* as a Moderation Strategy”** Twitter HQ
June 2018
Venue: *San Francisco, USA*
- **“Mining the Web to predict Future Events”** IIT Madras
July 2014
Venue: *Artificial Intelligence & Database Laboratory, IIT Madras*

Teaching Experience

- **Artificial Intelligence (OMSCS 6601)** Georgia Institute of Technology
Jan. - Apr. 2019
Teaching Assistant
 - Designed assignments, midterms, and examinations; office hours; tutorials; and evaluations
 - Class of approx. 400 students
- **Computing, Society and Professionalism (CS 4001)** Georgia Institute of Technology
Aug. - Dec. 2017
Teaching Assistant
 - Group discussions on ethical practices; evaluated assignments and examinations
 - Class of approx. 40 students
- **Social Computing (CS6474)** Georgia Institute of Technology
Aug. - Apr. 2015
Teaching Assistant
 - Graded assignments; led seminars and tutorials
 - Class of approx. 25 students
- **Natural Language Processing (CS6370)** Indian Institute of Technology, Madras
Jul. - Nov. 2014
Teaching Assistant
 - Office hours; project mentoring; and evaluations
 - Class of approx. 50 students

Service

- Organizing Committee - Local Arrangements Co-Chairs @ CSCW'19
- Program Committee - TRAC-1 (COLING'18), ALW 2018 (ACL'19)
- Reviewer - CHI'17, CHI'18, CSCW'17, CSCW'18, CSCW'19, TOCHI'18, ICWSM'19, ACL'19

Student Mentoring

- **Master's students:** Anirudh Srinivasan - GT CS (2016-2017), Chaitrali Gandhi - UM SI (2018-2019), Sonali Tandon - UM SI (2018-2019)
- **Undergraduate students:** Taha Ziad - UM SI (2019), Matthew Mustelie - UM SI (2019), Hunter Charvat - UM SI (2018), Christine Shih - GT CS (2017), Nancy Tao - GT CS (2016)